

Travel and Expenses Claim Pack — Finance Office

Finance Office, Expenses Section
Room 3.12, Administration Building, Main Campus

To the claimant,

This pack accompanies your overseas travel expense claim. It gathers in one document everything the Expenses Section refers to when a claim is checked: the Travel and Expenses Policy, the rate tables in force for the period of travel, the guide to completing the claim form with a worked specimen, the claim form itself, the receipt index, the approval routing, the standard letters you may receive, and the audit and appeals arrangements.

Only the claim form in Section 4 is to be completed. Every other section is for reference. Please check the form against the policy before submission: the commonest reasons for a claim being returned are a missing receipt, an expense type that does not match the receipt, and a subsistence claim that overlaps a meal already included in a conference fee or hotel rate.

Claims are processed in order of receipt. A complete claim is normally paid in the payroll run following approval; a claim returned for correction re-enters the queue on resubmission.

Expenses Section

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Section 1. Travel and Expenses Policy

This policy applies to all staff, research students and visitors who incur expenses on University business and seek reimbursement from University funds, whatever the source of those funds. It sets out what may be claimed, the evidence required, the limits that apply, and how claims are approved and paid. Grant-funded travel is additionally subject to the terms of the grant; where the funder's rules are stricter than this policy, the funder's rules apply.

1.1 Principles

1. Expenses are reimbursed only where they were necessarily incurred in the performance of University duties and were reasonable in amount.
2. The University reimburses actual cost against receipts, except where this policy provides a flat-rate allowance. An allowance may not be claimed in addition to the actual cost it replaces.
3. Travel must be by the most economical means consistent with the purpose of the journey and the reasonable convenience of the traveller. Where a more expensive option is chosen for personal reasons, the difference is borne by the traveller.
4. The claimant certifies that every item claimed was incurred on University business and has not been, and will not be, claimed from any other source.
5. The approver certifies that the travel was authorised, that the expenses are consistent with this policy, and that the funds are available in the cost centre charged.
6. No person may approve his or her own claim, a claim from a person to whom he or she reports, or a claim in which he or she has a personal interest.

1.2 Authorisation before travel

All overseas travel requires written authorisation before booking, using the travel authorisation form or the equivalent workflow in the finance system. The authorisation records the purpose of the journey, the destination, the dates, the estimated cost, and the cost centre to be charged. Travel booked without prior authorisation is reimbursed only where the head of department confirms in writing that it would have been authorised had it been requested; repeated instances are reported to the Dean.

Where the traveller will also take personal leave in the destination, the authorisation must state the business dates separately, and only expenses attributable to the business dates are reimbursed. Airfare is reimbursed in full where the fare would have been the same without the personal days; otherwise the traveller bears the difference.

1.3 Booking

Airfares and accommodation should be booked through the University's appointed travel agent, which applies the class-of-travel and accommodation-cap rules automatically and invoices the University directly. Where the agent cannot offer an itinerary that meets the requirements of the journey, the traveller may book directly and claim, keeping evidence that the agent's quotation was compared. Bookings made through online platforms must be supported by the platform's receipt showing the traveller's name, the dates and the amount paid, not merely a booking confirmation.

1.4 Class of travel

Air travel is in economy class for all journeys. Premium economy may be authorised by the Dean for a single flight sector exceeding eight hours where the traveller is required to work on the day of arrival, and business class only where a medical condition certified by the University's occupational health service

makes economy travel unsuitable. Rail travel is in standard class; first class may be used where it is cheaper at the time of booking. The class of travel entitlements are summarised in Section 2.3.

1.5 Accommodation

Accommodation is reimbursed at actual cost up to the nightly cap for the destination shown in Section 2.2, inclusive of taxes and service charges but exclusive of meals, minibar, laundry, telephone, film and other personal charges. Where the conference hotel exceeds the cap, the excess is reimbursed if the traveller can show that no suitable accommodation within the cap was available within reasonable distance of the venue. Accommodation with friends or family may be claimed at the flat rate in Section 2.2 without receipts.

1.6 Subsistence

Subsistence covers meals and incidental expenses while away from the normal place of work overnight. It is paid at the flat daily rate for the destination shown in Section 2.1, for each night spent away, without receipts. The rate is reduced by one third for each main meal provided by a conference, a host or a hotel rate. Subsistence is not paid for days on which the traveller was on personal leave. For journeys without an overnight stay, actual meal costs may be claimed against receipts up to the day-trip limit in Section 2.1.

1.7 Local transport

Public transport, airport transfers, taxis where public transport is impractical or unsafe, and hire cars where authorised are reimbursed at actual cost against receipts. A multi-day transport pass is reimbursed in full where it is cheaper than the single fares it replaces. Mileage for the use of a private vehicle is paid at the rate in Section 2.4 and requires the journey log on the claim form.

1.8 Conference and registration fees

Registration fees are reimbursed against the organiser's receipt. Where the fee includes meals or accommodation, the subsistence and accommodation claims for the corresponding days are reduced accordingly. Membership fees of a society are not reimbursed as an expense even where membership reduces the registration fee; they may be charged to a research account where the funder permits.

1.9 Other business expenses

Items such as printing of research posters, shipping of equipment or specimens, visa fees, vaccination costs required for the destination, and business telephone and internet charges while away are reimbursed against receipts where they were necessary for the purpose of the journey. Items of equipment purchased while travelling remain University property and must be recorded in the departmental inventory on return.

1.10 Non-reimbursable items

- Alcohol, other than a moderate amount with a meal that is itself reimbursable under a hospitality authorisation.
- Personal entertainment, fitness or spa charges, films, and newspapers.
- Travel insurance purchased privately; the University's policy covers all authorised travel.
- Parking fines, speeding fines, and any other penalty.
- Costs of a spouse, partner or other accompanying person.
- Upgrades of any kind chosen by the traveller.
- Tips and gratuities above 10 percent of the underlying charge.

- Loss of personal cash or property.
- Charges arising from a failure to cancel a booking that was no longer needed.

1.11 Receipts and evidence

Every item claimed, other than a flat-rate allowance, must be supported by an original receipt or an electronic receipt showing the supplier, the date, the amount, and the nature of the goods or service. Credit card statements and booking confirmations are not receipts. Where a receipt has been lost, the missing-receipt declaration in Section 5 must be completed and countersigned by the approver; the Expenses Section may refuse an item where declarations are used repeatedly. Receipts in a language other than English or Chinese should be annotated with a short description of the item.

1.12 Foreign currency

Expenses incurred in a foreign currency are converted to Hong Kong dollars at the University's monthly rate for the month in which the expense was incurred, published in Section 2.5. Where the traveller can show, by a card statement, the actual rate charged, that rate may be used instead. Exchange commission and foreign transaction fees charged by the traveller's bank are reimbursable against the statement showing them.

1.13 Advances

A cash advance may be requested for overseas travel where the estimated out-of-pocket cost exceeds HK\$ 5,000. The advance is deducted from the claim; where the claim is less than the advance, the balance must be repaid within 14 days of return. No further advance is issued while an earlier advance remains unaccounted for.

1.14 Timing

Claims must be submitted within 60 days of the return date. Claims submitted later than 60 days require the written approval of the head of department with an explanation of the delay, and claims submitted later than six months after the return date are not reimbursed except in exceptional circumstances approved by the Director of Finance. Expenses incurred in one financial year must be claimed in that year where possible; the year-end cut-off is announced each June.

1.15 Approval and payment

Each claim is approved by the budget holder of the cost centre charged, within the delegated limits in Section 6, and is then checked by the Expenses Section for compliance with this policy. Payment is made by bank transfer to the claimant's salary account in the payroll run following approval. Where a claim is charged to more than one cost centre, each budget holder approves his or her share.

1.16 Audit

The Expenses Section examines every claim for arithmetic, receipts and policy compliance, and Internal Audit examines a sample of approved claims each quarter. Findings are reported to the head of department and, where a claim was approved in breach of this policy, to the Director of Finance. Amounts paid in error are recovered from the claimant through payroll. Deliberate misstatement of a claim is treated as gross misconduct under the disciplinary procedure.

1.17 Fieldwork and hazardous travel

Fieldwork away from an established institution, and travel to a destination for which the Security Bureau has issued an outbound travel alert, require a risk assessment approved by the head of department before authorisation. The risk assessment covers the itinerary, local contacts, communication arrangements, medical facilities, and the actions to be taken if the traveller cannot be contacted.

Expenses that arise from the mitigation measures in an approved risk assessment — satellite communication hire, a local guide or driver, additional accommodation nights for acclimatisation — are reimbursable against receipts even where they would otherwise fall outside this policy. Travel to a destination under a red or black alert is not authorised except by the Vice-President (Research) on the recommendation of the University's security adviser.

1.18 Insurance

All authorised travel is covered by the University's group travel insurance, which provides medical expenses, emergency evacuation, personal accident, loss of baggage and travel documents, and cancellation cover arising from illness, bereavement or the withdrawal of a conference. The cover applies from departure to return and includes up to seven days of personal leave taken in conjunction with the business travel. Claims under the insurance are made to the insurer, not through the expense claim; the Finance Office issues the policy summary and the emergency assistance number with each authorisation. Where a loss is not recoverable under the insurance — for example an excess, or an item excluded by the policy — it is not reimbursable as an expense either, except where the head of department accepts that the loss arose directly from the performance of University duties.

1.19 Grant-funded travel

Travel charged to an external grant is subject to both this policy and the funder's terms. The principal investigator is responsible for confirming, before authorisation, that the travel is an allowable cost under the grant, that it falls within the grant period, and that the budget line has sufficient balance. Where the funder's rules are stricter — a lower subsistence rate, a requirement for receipts for every item, a prohibition on business-class travel in any circumstance — the stricter rule applies and the difference cannot be charged to another University fund. Where the funder's rules are more generous, this policy still applies. The commonest funder restrictions are summarised below; the grant terms themselves prevail.

Funder type	Subsistence	Receipts	Class of travel	Timing
Research Grants Council (general research fund)	University rate	Required over HK\$ 200	Economy only	Within grant period
Innovation and Technology Fund	University rate, capped at 90% of published civil-service rate	Required for all items	Economy only	Within project period; pre-approval for overseas
Overseas government funders	Funder's own per diem tables	Funder's rules	Economy; premium with written approval	Funder's reporting period
Industry sponsors	As stated in the agreement	As stated in the agreement	As stated in the agreement	Agreement period
Charitable foundations	University rate unless capped	Required for all items	Economy only	Within award period

1.20 Hospitality while travelling

A meal or refreshment offered to an external guest while travelling — a collaborator, a prospective recruit, a funder's representative — is hospitality, not subsistence, and requires the hospitality authorisation on the claim form to be completed with the names and affiliations of the guests and the business purpose. Hospitality is reimbursed at actual cost against an itemised receipt up to the per-head limit of HK\$ 600 for a meal and HK\$ 120 for refreshments, inclusive of a moderate amount of alcohol with a meal. The claimant's own share of a hospitality meal is claimed as hospitality and the subsistence rate for that day is reduced accordingly.

1.21 University procurement cards

Holders of a University procurement card may pay travel expenses with the card where the supplier accepts it. Card transactions are not claimed on the expense form; they are reconciled monthly through the card statement, with receipts attached to the statement and the same policy limits applied. Subsistence, which is a flat-rate allowance, cannot be paid with the card and is claimed on the expense form in the usual way. Cash withdrawals on the card are not permitted except in an emergency notified to the Finance Office within one working day.

1.22 Sustainable travel

The University reports the carbon emissions of business travel and expects travellers to consider whether a journey is necessary, whether the purpose could be achieved by video conference, and whether rail is practicable for journeys under six hours. The travel authorisation records the traveller's assessment. Where rail is available at a total cost within twenty percent of the air fare and the journey time is within six hours, rail is the expected mode and air travel requires the head of department's approval. Carbon offsets purchased privately are not reimbursable; the University offsets centrally.

1.23 Visiting scholars and external examiners

Visitors whose travel is paid by the University are reimbursed under this policy on the visitor claim form, which follows the same layout as form EXPGEN2 but pays to a nominated bank account rather than a salary account. A visitor without a Hong Kong bank account is paid by telegraphic transfer, and the transfer charge is borne by the University. Visitors are asked to submit claims within 30 days of the visit so that departmental budgets can be closed.

1.24 Booking through the appointed travel agent

The appointed agent holds the University's negotiated fares and hotel rates and applies this policy at the point of booking. Bookings are made by e-mail or through the agent's online portal using the traveller's University account, quoting the travel authorisation number. The agent issues an itinerary and an invoice to the cost centre; the traveller receives an e-ticket and, for hotels, a voucher. Changes and cancellations are made through the agent, which advises the fare rules and any charge before confirming.

Fare rule	What it means for the traveller	Policy position
Non-refundable	No refund if cancelled; taxes may be recoverable	Default for conferences with fixed dates
Changeable with fee	Dates may be changed on payment of a fee plus fare difference	Preferred where dates may move; fee reimbursable where the change was for business reasons
Fully flexible	Refundable and changeable without fee	Only where the head of department confirms the itinerary is genuinely uncertain
Basic economy (no bag, no seat selection)	Lowest fare; baggage charged separately	Acceptable; baggage charge reimbursable
Codeshare	Ticket issued by one carrier for a flight operated by another	Acceptable; the operating carrier's baggage rules apply
Open-jaw	Arrival and departure at different cities	Acceptable where it serves the itinerary

Where the agent's fare is more than fifteen percent above a fare the traveller has found elsewhere for the same itinerary and fare rule, the traveller may book directly and claim, attaching a screenshot of both fares taken on the same day. The Finance Office reviews these comparisons quarterly with the agent.

1.25 Hotel bookings and no-shows

Hotel bookings through the agent are guaranteed to the University's account and invoiced after the stay. A booking that is not cancelled by the hotel's deadline and not used is charged as a no-show; the charge is borne by the cost centre where the failure to cancel was outside the traveller's control, and otherwise

by the traveller. Extra nights added at the hotel by the traveller are settled by the traveller and claimed with the hotel's receipt.

Section 2. Rate Tables (in force for travel from 1 January 2026)

2.1 Overseas subsistence — flat daily rate, HK\$ per night away (meals and incidentals)

Destination	Rate	Destination	Rate
Australia - Melbourne	610	Japan - Tokyo	640
Australia - Sydney	630	Korea - Seoul	560
Canada - Toronto	590	Netherlands - Amsterdam	600
Canada - Vancouver	580	Singapore	570
China - Beijing	480	Spain - Barcelona	540
China - Shanghai	500	Sweden - Stockholm	620
France - Paris	620	Switzerland - Geneva	700
Germany - Berlin	560	Switzerland - Zurich	710
Germany - Munich	580	Taiwan - Taipei	470
Italy - Milan	580	United Kingdom - London	680
Italy - Rome	570	United Kingdom - Manchester	590
United States - Boston	660	United States - New York	720
United States - San Diego	620	United States - San Francisco	700
Other destinations	500	Day trip without overnight stay (against receipts)	up to 300

The rate is reduced by one third for each main meal provided. Nights are counted from the date of departure to the date of return; a journey of five nights is paid at five times the rate regardless of the time of arrival on the last day.

2.2 Accommodation — nightly cap, HK\$ inclusive of taxes

Destination	Cap	Destination	Cap
Australia - Melbourne	1,500	Japan - Tokyo	1,600
Australia - Sydney	1,700	Korea - Seoul	1,300
Canada - Toronto	1,500	Netherlands - Amsterdam	1,700
Canada - Vancouver	1,500	Singapore	1,600
China - Beijing	1,100	Spain - Barcelona	1,400
China - Shanghai	1,200	Sweden - Stockholm	1,700
France - Paris	1,800	Switzerland - Geneva	2,100
Germany - Berlin	1,500	Switzerland - Zurich	2,200
Germany - Munich	1,700	Taiwan - Taipei	1,100
Italy - Milan	1,600	United Kingdom - London	2,000
Italy - Rome	1,500	United Kingdom - Manchester	1,400
United States - Boston	2,000	United States - New York	2,400
United States - San Diego	1,800	United States - San Francisco	2,300
Other destinations	1,300	Staying with friends or family (flat rate, no receipt)	250

2.3 Class of travel entitlement

Mode	Standard entitlement	Exception	Approver for the exception
Air, any sector	Economy	Premium economy where a single sector exceeds 8 hours and work is required on arrival	Dean
Air, any sector	Economy	Business class on certified medical grounds	Director of Finance
Rail	Standard class	First class where cheaper at booking	None required
Ferry	Economy	Cabin on overnight crossings	Head of department
Hire car	Compact or intermediate	Larger vehicle where 4 or more travel together or equipment is carried	Head of department
Taxi	Where public transport impractical, unsafe, or unavailable	—	None required

2.4 Mileage and other flat rates

Item	Rate
Private car, per kilometre	HK\$ 4.20
Motorcycle, per kilometre	HK\$ 1.80
Bicycle, per kilometre	HK\$ 0.90
Passenger supplement, per passenger per kilometre	HK\$ 0.40
Home working allowance while abroad for more than 14 days, per week	HK\$ 150
Overnight incidental allowance within Hong Kong (no meals), per night	HK\$ 120

2.5 Monthly exchange rates — HK\$ per unit of foreign currency

Month	EUR	GBP	USD	JPY (per 100)	AUD	SGD	CNY	KRW (per 1,000)
October 2025	8.47	10.18	7.78	5.14	5.05	6.02	1.09	5.62
November 2025	8.42	10.10	7.78	5.09	5.02	6.00	1.09	5.58
December 2025	8.40	10.05	7.78	5.03	5.00	5.98	1.08	5.51
January 2026	8.36	9.98	7.78	4.98	4.97	5.95	1.08	5.47
February 2026	8.39	10.02	7.78	5.01	4.99	5.97	1.08	5.50
March 2026	8.41	10.07	7.78	5.05	5.01	5.99	1.09	5.53

Rates are the mid-market rate on the first working day of the month, published by the Finance Office. On the claim form the rate is entered to four decimal places.

2.6 Country notes for frequently visited destinations

The notes below are maintained by the Finance Office with the University's travel agent and security adviser. They summarise entry requirements, health precautions and local practice that affect what a traveller may need to claim. They are not a substitute for the official advice of the destination's consulate, which the traveller should check before booking.

Destination	Entry	Health	Local practice affecting claims
Germany	Visa-free for HKSAR passport holders up to 90 days in the Schengen area; ETIAS authorisation expected to apply from 2026	No vaccinations required; European Health Insurance Card not available to non-EU travellers, so insurance card must be carried	City tax added to hotel bills is reimbursable; transport passes (day, week, month) are usually cheaper than singles from the second day
United Kingdom	Visa-free up to 6 months; Electronic Travel Authorisation required from 2025	No vaccinations required	Hotel VAT is included in the rate and reimbursable; rail fares vary widely by booking time — advance tickets expected
United States	ESTA required for visa-waiver travel; apply at least 72 hours before departure	No vaccinations required	Hotel rates exclude tax and resort fees, which are reimbursable; tipping of 15–20% is customary and reimbursable within the 10% policy limit only up to that limit
Japan	Visa-free up to 90 days	No vaccinations required	Consumption tax is included in prices; IC transit cards are refundable and the deposit is not claimable
South Korea	K-ETA may be required; check before booking	No vaccinations required	Hotel rates usually include tax and service; taxis are inexpensive and receipts are printed on request
Singapore	Visa-free up to 30 days; SG Arrival Card required	No vaccinations required	Goods and services tax is reimbursable; hotel service charge is included in the rate
Australia	Electronic visa (ETA or eVisitor) required	No vaccinations required; strict biosecurity on food and biological samples	Goods and services tax is reimbursable; accommodation in Sydney regularly exceeds the cap during conference season — pre-authorise
Mainland China	Visa or permit as applicable to the traveller's document	No vaccinations required	Fapiao (official receipt) must be obtained for every item; a card slip is not accepted
Switzerland	Visa-free up to 90 days in the	No vaccinations required	Hotel guest cards often include free public

	Schengen area		transport — claim no transport pass where one is provided
Canada	eTA required for air arrivals	No vaccinations required	Provincial sales taxes are reimbursable; rates in Vancouver exceed the cap in summer — pre-authorise

2.7 Worked examples of subsistence reductions

Situation	Nights	Rate	Reduction	Amount claimed
Conference, breakfast included in hotel rate every night	3	680	$1/3 \times 680 \times 3 = 680.00$	1,360.00
Conference, breakfast and conference lunch on two days	3	620	$1/3 \times 620 \times 3 + 1/3 \times 620 \times 2 = 1,033.33$	826.67
Host provides all meals	5	480	Full	0.00
Personal leave on two of six nights	4 (business)	600	None on business nights	2,400.00
Day trip, no overnight stay	0	—	Actual meals against receipts	up to 300.00

Amounts in this table are illustrations of the arithmetic at the 2026 rates and do not relate to any particular claim.

2.8 Typical airfare bands used for authorisation estimates (economy, return, HK\$)

Route	Low season	High season	Notes
Hong Kong – Singapore	2,200 – 3,500	3,500 – 5,000	Frequent daily services
Hong Kong – Tokyo	3,000 – 4,500	4,500 – 7,000	Peak in cherry-blossom season and Golden Week
Hong Kong – Seoul	2,500 – 3,800	3,800 – 5,500	—
Hong Kong – Sydney	5,500 – 8,000	8,000 – 11,000	Peak December–January
Hong Kong – London	7,000 – 10,000	10,000 – 14,000	Direct services daily
Hong Kong – Frankfurt or Berlin	7,500 – 11,000	11,000 – 15,000	Berlin usually via Frankfurt or Munich
Hong Kong – Paris	7,500 – 11,000	11,000 – 15,000	—
Hong Kong – Zurich	8,000 – 11,500	11,500 – 15,500	—
Hong Kong – San Francisco	7,000 – 10,500	10,500 – 14,000	—
Hong Kong – New York	8,500 – 12,000	12,000 – 16,000	Direct services limited; via West Coast common
Hong Kong – Toronto	8,500 – 12,000	12,000 – 16,500	—

Bands are indicative and drawn from the travel agent's bookings in the previous year. They are used to check the estimate on a travel authorisation, not to cap the fare claimed.

2.9 Overseas subsistence and accommodation — full destination list (HK\$)

The tables in 2.1 and 2.2 list the most frequently visited destinations. The full list follows. Where a city is not listed, the country rate applies; where the country is not listed, the Other destinations rate applies.

Destination	Subsistence per night	Accommodation cap	Destination	Subsistence per night	Accommodation cap
Austria - Vienna	590	1,600	Malaysia - Kuala Lumpur	420	900
Belgium - Brussels	600	1,700	Mexico - Mexico City	480	1,200
Brazil - São Paulo	520	1,300	Netherlands - Rotterdam	570	1,500
Canada - Montreal	560	1,400	New Zealand - Auckland	560	1,400
Chile - Santiago	500	1,200	New Zealand - Wellington	550	1,300
China - Guangzhou	460	1,000	Norway - Oslo	700	1,900
China - Hangzhou	450	1,000	Philippines - Manila	400	900
China - Shenzhen	470	1,100	Poland - Warsaw	480	1,200
Czech Republic - Prague	500	1,300	Portugal - Lisbon	520	1,400
Denmark - Copenhagen	680	1,900	Qatar - Doha	620	1,600
Finland - Helsinki	640	1,700	Saudi Arabia - Riyadh	600	1,600

France - Lyon	560	1,400	Singapore	570	1,600
Germany - Frankfurt	580	1,600	South Africa - Cape Town	460	1,100
Germany - Hamburg	560	1,500	Spain - Madrid	550	1,400
Germany - Berlin	560	1,500	Sweden - Gothenburg	600	1,600
Greece - Athens	500	1,200	Switzerland - Basel	690	2,000
Hungary - Budapest	470	1,100	Switzerland - Lausanne	690	2,000
India - Bengaluru	400	1,000	Thailand - Bangkok	420	900
India - Mumbai	430	1,100	Turkey - Istanbul	470	1,100
India - New Delhi	420	1,000	United Arab Emirates - Abu Dhabi	640	1,700
Indonesia - Jakarta	410	900	United Arab Emirates - Dubai	660	1,800
Ireland - Dublin	640	1,800	United Kingdom - Cambridge	640	1,700
Israel - Tel Aviv	660	1,800	United Kingdom - Edinburgh	610	1,600
Italy - Bologna	540	1,300	United Kingdom - Oxford	640	1,700
Italy - Florence	560	1,400	United States - Atlanta	620	1,700
Japan - Kyoto	600	1,500	United States - Chicago	660	1,900
Japan - Osaka	590	1,400	United States - Houston	600	1,600
Korea - Busan	520	1,200	United States - Los Angeles	680	2,100
Korea - Daejeon	500	1,100	United States - Seattle	670	2,000
Macau	450	1,100	United States - Washington DC	700	2,200

Effective for travel from 1 January 2026. Rates are reviewed annually against the civil-service subsistence tables and the travel agent's average booked hotel rates for the previous year.

Section 3. Guide to Completing the Claim Form

The claim form (form EXPGEN2) has a header block, a receipts table, a subsistence table, and a declaration. Complete it in the order below. Amounts are entered in Hong Kong dollars with cents; foreign amounts are entered in the receipt currency with the exchange rate alongside.

3.1 Header

- Name: as held on the staff record, surname first, exactly as it appears on the payslip. The finance system matches the claim to the payroll record by name and staff number.
- Staff number and cost centre: from the payslip or the departmental office. The cost centre determines who approves the claim; a wrong cost centre routes the claim to the wrong approver and delays it.
- Purpose and justification: state the business purpose in full, naming the conference, host institution or project, and the agreement or grant under which the travel took place. Claims giving only a city name are returned.
- Destination: from the list in Section 2.1, in the form Country - City. Where the destination is not listed, write Other destinations and name the city in the justification.
- Type of claim and reimbursement currency: Overseas Travelling for any journey outside Hong Kong; the reimbursement currency is always HKD.

3.2 Receipts table

- One line per receipt, in date order. The receipt date is the date on the receipt, not the date of travel; for an airfare it is the date of purchase.
- Expense type: choose from the list printed on the reverse of the form (and reproduced in the glossary, Section 9). Airfare, accommodation and local transport are Travelling types; registration fees are Conference types; anything that fits no type is Others, with a description that makes the item clear.
- Description: what was bought, from whom, and for how long where relevant — for example the route and carrier for an airfare, the hotel and number of nights for accommodation.
- Receipt currency and amount: exactly as printed on the receipt. Exchange rate: from Section 2.5, to four decimal places; 1.0000 for HKD receipts. Reimbursable amount: receipt amount multiplied by the rate, rounded to the cent.

3.3 Subsistence table

- One line per destination. The expense type is Travelling - Subsistence Allowance. Start and end dates are the dates of departure from and return to Hong Kong; nights is the number of nights between them.
- The amount is nights multiplied by the rate in Section 2.1, less one third of the rate for each meal provided. Note any meals provided in the description.

3.4 Advance, declaration and submission

Enter any advance received; the finance system deducts it. Sign and date the declaration. Attach the receipts in the order of the table, numbered to match, and submit the form to the departmental office, which forwards it to the approver. Electronic submission through the finance system is available to departments enrolled in the pilot; the rules are the same.

3.5 Frequently asked questions

The hotel included breakfast. What do I claim?

Claim the room rate in full up to the cap, and reduce the subsistence claim by one third of the daily rate for each night on which breakfast was provided. Note breakfast included in the subsistence description.

My flight was paid by the travel agent. Do I list it?

No. Items invoiced directly to the University are not claimed; they are already charged to the cost centre. List only what you paid yourself.

I paid in euros on a card. Which rate do I use?

Either the monthly rate in Section 2.5 for the month of the receipt, or the actual rate on your card statement if you attach the statement. Use one method for the whole claim.

I lost the receipt for a taxi.

Complete the missing-receipt declaration in Section 5 for that item and have the approver countersign it. Taxi items under HK\$ 100 may be declared without countersignature.

Can I claim the conference dinner?

If the dinner was part of the registration fee, it is already paid; reduce subsistence for that day. If it was an optional ticket, it is reimbursable only where attendance served a business purpose confirmed by the approver.

The claim is for a trip six months ago.

Attach the head of department's written approval and an explanation of the delay. Claims older than six months are not paid except with the Director of Finance's approval.

The conference organiser paid my hotel directly.

Do not claim it. Reduce your subsistence for any meals the organiser provided and note the arrangement in the justification.

I extended the trip by three days of leave.

Claim the airfare in full if the fare would have been the same for the business dates alone, and attach the agent's confirmation that it was. Claim accommodation and subsistence only for the business nights. Give both sets of dates in the justification.

Two of us shared a hotel room.

One traveller claims the whole room charge; the other claims nothing for accommodation and notes the arrangement. Both claim subsistence.

I paid for a colleague's taxi as well as my own.

Claim the whole fare and list the colleague's name in the description. The colleague claims nothing for that journey.

The airline charged for checked baggage.

A baggage charge on an economy fare is part of the airfare and is claimed as Travelling - Airfare (Basic Economy Class) with the receipt. Excess baggage for equipment is claimed as Others with the reason stated.

Do I need to convert receipts myself?

Yes. Enter the receipt currency and amount, the rate to four decimal places, and the converted amount. The Expenses Section re-performs the arithmetic and will correct a rounding difference of less than one dollar without returning the claim.

What counts as a night?

A night away is counted for each date of departure up to but not including the date of return. Depart on the 2nd and return on the 7th: five nights.

Where do I find my cost centre?

On the payslip, in the top right, or from the departmental office. Grant-funded travel uses the grant's cost centre, which the principal investigator will give you; it is not the department's teaching or research-pool code.

Can I submit a claim for a trip that has not finished?

No. A claim covers a completed journey. For a long placement, interim claims may be submitted monthly with the head of department's agreement, each covering a completed calendar month.

Who signs if my head of department is away?

The deputy head, or the Dean, as the delegated authority table in Section 6 provides. An approval by a person without delegated authority is not valid and the claim is returned.

3.6 Worked specimen

The following pages show a specimen claim form completed for an imaginary two-night conference trip, to illustrate how each block is filled in. The particulars are fictitious and are printed for guidance only. Do not copy any value from the specimen into your own claim.

SPECIMEN — FOR GUIDANCE ONLY — NOT A CLAIM

UNIVERSITY FINANCE OFFICE EXPENSES CLAIM FORM — TRAVEL AND SUBSISTENCE <i>To be completed in BLOCK CAPITALS by the claimant. Original receipts must be attached. Please read Notes 1 to 4 below before completing.</i>	EXPGEN2 FO RL 22 4 25 SPECIMEN — FOR GUIDANCE ONLY
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For the Period: From 1 January 2026 To 3 January 2026 **Claim Reference:** TEC-0000-0000
Type of Claim: Overseas Travelling

Surname SAMPLE	Forenames Specimen	Payroll No 00000000	National Insurance No AA 00 00 00 A
Name of Claimant (as held on the staff record) Sample Specimen	Post Held Post title as on the staff record	Telephone Extension 0000 0000	Cost Centre to be charged 00000
Department Department (as on the staff record)	E-mail specimen@example.edu	Home Address 1 Example Road, Example Estate, Kowloon	
Reason for payment / Justification of expense claim (Note 1) Conference — Example: presentation of an accepted paper at the International Conference on Example Studies, London. Destination: United Kingdom - London.			

SUMMARY OF CLAIM

Enter the total for each category below. Full details of every item must be given in the Analysis of Expenditure overleaf (Note 2). Categories with no expenditure are to be left blank.

NB	Category of expenditure — please give full details overleaf	HKD	cents
	Air travel	1,000	00
	Rail and other travel	—	
	Accommodation	2,000	00
	Conference and registration fees	200	00
	Subsistence	—	
	Other incidentals (receipts attached)	—	
	** TOTAL INCURRED (HKD)	4,200	00
	If you received an advance please enter amount >>>>	Nil	
	BALANCE DUE TO THE CLAIMANT	4,200	00

ANALYSIS OF EXPENDITURE (Note 3)

Expenditure Date	Expense Type	Details of expenditure	Currency	Amount (foreign currency)	Exchange Rate	Amount HKD
01-JAN-2026	Travelling - Airfare (Basic Economy Class)	Example return airfare HKG-LHR	HKD	1,000.00	1.0000	1,000.00
01-JAN-2026	Travelling - Accommodation	Example hotel, 2 nights	GBP	200.00	10.0000	2,000.00
02-JAN-2026	Conference - Other Conference Expenses	Example poster printing	GBP	20.00	10.0000	200.00

SUBSISTENCE CLAIMED

Expense Type	From	To	Destination	Details	Nights	Amount HKD
Travelling - Subsistence Allowance	01-JAN-2026	03-JAN-2026	United Kingdom - London	Meals and incidentals (breakfast provided, reduced)	2	1,000.00

Name of Bank Example Bank Limited	Account Name SAMPLE SPECIMEN	Account No 000-000000-000	Sort Code 00-00-00
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Bank details are required only where they differ from those held on the payroll record (Note 4).

DECLARATION

I certify that the expenditure detailed above was incurred by me wholly, exclusively and necessarily in the course of University business, that the receipts attached are originals, and that no other claim has been or will be made in respect of these items.

Signature of Claimant Date

AUTHORISATION

I certify that funds are available against the cost centre shown and that this claim complies with the University's travel policy. The authorising signatory must be senior in status to the claimant.

Authorised by (PRINT & SIGNATURE) Date

Cost Centre	GL Code	WBS Element	SIO	VAT Code	Checked
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FOR FINANCE OFFICE USE ONLY — DESCRIPTION FOR POSTING TO AGRESSO

Note 1. State the business purpose of the travel in full. Claims giving only a destination will be returned.

Note 2. Categories are pre-printed. Leave a category blank where no expenditure was incurred against it.

Note 3. Where expenditure was incurred in a currency other than HKD, state the amount in the original currency together with the rate applied. The market rate published on the first day of travel may be used for the whole trip.

Note 4. Claims received more than 60 days after the end of travel must be accompanied by a written explanation.

EXPGEN2 University Finance Office Page 1 of 1

END OF SPECIMEN — the particulars above are fictitious.

Section 4. Claim Form (completed)

The claim form for this journey follows on the next page. It was completed by the claimant from the receipts listed in Section 5 and is the source of every value to be entered when the claim is lodged in the finance system. The specimen in Section 3.6 is an illustration only and must not be used.

UNIVERSITY FINANCE OFFICE

EXPENSES CLAIM FORM — TRAVEL AND SUBSISTENCE

To be completed in BLOCK CAPITALS by the claimant. Original receipts must be attached. Please read Notes 1 to 4 below before completing.

EXPGEN2

FO RL 22 4 25

For the Period: From 18 November 2025 To 22 November 2025

Claim Reference: TEC-2026-0522

Type of Claim: Overseas Travelling

Surname WONG	Forenames Siu Fung	Payroll No 00204117	National Insurance No SN 51 09 77 B
Name of Claimant (as held on the staff record) Wong Siu Fung	Post Held Senior Research Fellow	Telephone Extension 3411 6642	Cost Centre to be charged 21350
Department Department of Industrial Engineering	E-mail sf.wong@univ.edu.hk	Home Address Block 4, 22/F, Parkside Gardens, 88 Broadcast Drive, Kowloon	
Reason for payment / Justification of expense claim (Note 1) Research Visit — Joint experimental work with the Fraunhofer Institute for Production Systems under collaboration agreement CA-2025-114, Berlin. Destination: Germany - Berlin.			

SUMMARY OF CLAIM

Enter the total for each category below. Full details of every item must be given in the Analysis of Expenditure overleaf (Note 2). Categories with no expenditure are to be left blank.

NB	Category of expenditure — please give full details overleaf	HKD	cents
	Air travel	11,240	00
	Rail and other travel	353	64
	Accommodation	5,153	04
	Conference and registration fees	—	
	Subsistence	—	
	Other incidentals (receipts attached)	307	33
	** TOTAL INCURRED (HKD)	19,294	01
	If you received an advance please enter amount >>>>	3,000	00
	BALANCE DUE TO THE CLAIMANT	16,294	01

ANALYSIS OF EXPENDITURE (Note 3)

Expenditure Date	Expense Type	Details of expenditure	Currency	Amount (foreign currency)	Exchange Rate	Amount HKD
18-NOV-2025	Travelling - Airfare (Basic Economy Class)	Return economy airfare HKG-BER, Lufthansa	HKD	11,240.00	1.0000	11,240.00
18-NOV-2025	Travelling - Accommodation	Hotel Adlon Annex, 4 nights	EUR	612.00	8.4200	5,153.04
19-NOV-2025	Travelling - Other Travelling Expenses	Berlin public transport pass, 5 days	EUR	42.00	8.4200	353.64
21-NOV-2025	Others	Poster printing for site seminar	EUR	36.50	8.4200	307.33

SUBSISTENCE CLAIMED

Expense Type	From	To	Destination	Details	Nights	Amount HKD
Travelling - Subsistence Allowance	18-NOV-2025	22-NOV-2025	Germany - Berlin	Meals and incidentals	4	2,240.00

Name of Bank	Account Name	Account No	Sort Code
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Bank of China (Hong Kong)	WONG SIU FUNG	012-660418-004	01-26-60
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Bank details are required only where they differ from those held on the payroll record (Note 4).

DECLARATION

I certify that the expenditure detailed above was incurred by me wholly, exclusively and necessarily in the course of University business, that the receipts attached are originals, and that no other claim has been or will be made in respect of these items.

Signature of Claimant Date

AUTHORISATION

I certify that funds are available against the cost centre shown and that this claim complies with the University's travel policy. The authorising signatory must be senior in status to the claimant.

Authorised by (PRINT & SIGNATURE) Date

Cost Centre	GL Code	WBS Element	SIO	VAT Code	Checked
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FOR FINANCE OFFICE USE ONLY — DESCRIPTION FOR POSTING TO AGRESSO

Note 1. State the business purpose of the travel in full. Claims giving only a destination will be returned.

Note 2. Categories are pre-printed. Leave a category blank where no expenditure was incurred against it.

Note 3. Where expenditure was incurred in a currency other than HKD, state the amount in the original currency together with the rate applied. The market rate published on the first day of travel may be used for the whole trip.

Note 4. Claims received more than 60 days after the end of travel must be accompanied by a written explanation.

EXPGEN2

University Finance Office

Page 1 of 1

Section 5. Receipts and Enclosures

The receipts for this claim are attached as originals behind the claim form and are not reproduced in this pack. The index below records what is enclosed, numbered to match the receipts table on the form. Amounts are on the receipts themselves.

No.	Supplier	Nature of receipt	Currency	Original / Electronic
1	Lufthansa	Airline e-ticket receipt, return economy	HKD	Electronic
2	Motel One Alexanderplatz	Hotel invoice, room and city tax	EUR	Original
3	Berliner Verkehrsbetriebe	Multi-day public transport pass	EUR	Original
4	DHL Express	Courier consignment to the host laboratory	EUR	Electronic
—	—	Subsistence: no receipts (flat rate)	—	—

5.1 Missing-receipt declaration (blank)

To be completed only where an original receipt cannot be produced. One declaration per item. The approver's countersignature is required for items of HK\$ 100 or more.

Item	Entry
Item number on the claim form	
Date of expense	
Supplier	
Nature of the expense	
Amount and currency	
Reason the receipt cannot be produced	
Claimant's signature and date	
Approver's countersignature and date	

5.2 Travel authorisation reference

The travel authorisation for this journey was approved in the finance system before booking. The authorisation number is quoted on the claim form under the claim reference and is checked by the Expenses Section against the system record; a claim whose authorisation cannot be found is returned.

Section 6. Approval Routing and Delegated Limits

A claim is routed by the cost centre it charges. The budget holder approves within the limit delegated to the post; a claim above the limit is escalated to the next level. Approvers must satisfy themselves that the travel was authorised, that each item is consistent with the policy, and that the arithmetic is correct.

Level	Post	Limit per claim (HK\$)	Escalates to
1	Principal investigator or cost centre manager	20,000	Head of department
2	Head of department	60,000	Dean of faculty
3	Dean of faculty	150,000	Director of Finance
4	Director of Finance	Unlimited	—

6.1 Cost centre directory (extract — faculties of Engineering and Science)

Cost centre	Unit	Budget holder post
14700	Department of Computer Science	Head of Department
14710	Computer Science — research grants pool	Associate Head (Research)
21350	Department of Industrial Engineering	Head of Department
21360	Industrial Engineering — laboratories	Laboratory Manager
30400	Department of Mechanical Engineering — teaching	Head of Department
30410	Mechanical Engineering — research grants pool	Associate Head (Research)
30430	Mechanical Engineering — laboratories	Laboratory Manager
30450	Mechanical Engineering — postgraduate programme	Programme Director
41200	Department of Physics	Head of Department
41220	Physics — research grants pool	Associate Head (Research)
52100	Department of Chemistry	Head of Department
52130	Chemistry — laboratories	Laboratory Manager
60010	Faculty of Engineering — Dean's office	Dean
60020	Faculty of Science — Dean's office	Dean

The full directory of 340 cost centres is in the finance system. A research grant has its own cost centre; travel funded by a grant is charged to that centre and approved by the principal investigator within level 1.

6.2 Cost centre directory — extended extract

Cost centre	Unit	Budget holder post	Cost centre	Unit	Budget holder post
10100	Office of the President	Chief of Staff	41230	Physics — laboratories	Laboratory Manager
10200	Vice-President (Research)	Director of Research Office	41250	Physics — postgraduate programme	Programme Director
10300	Vice-President (Administration)	Director of Administration	52110	Chemistry — research grants pool	Associate Head (Research)
11000	Registry	Registrar	52150	Chemistry — postgraduate programme	Programme Director
12000	Library	University Librarian	53100	Department of Biology	Head of Department
13000	Information Technology Services	Director of ITS	53110	Biology — research grants pool	Associate Head (Research)
14720	Computer Science — laboratories	Laboratory Manager	53130	Biology — field station	Station Manager
14750	Computer Science — postgraduate programme	Programme Director	54100	Department of Mathematics	Head of Department
15100	Department of Electrical Engineering	Head of Department	54110	Mathematics — research grants pool	Associate Head (Research)
15110	Electrical Engineering — research grants pool	Associate Head (Research)	60030	Faculty of Business — Dean's office	Dean
15130	Electrical Engineering —	Laboratory	60040	Faculty of Arts — Dean's office	Dean

	laboratories	Manager			
16100	Department of Civil Engineering	Head of Department	61100	Department of Economics	Head of Department
16110	Civil Engineering — research grants pool	Associate Head (Research)	61200	Department of Management	Head of Department
16130	Civil Engineering — structures laboratory	Laboratory Manager	62100	Department of English	Head of Department
17100	Department of Chemical Engineering	Head of Department	62200	Department of History	Head of Department
17110	Chemical Engineering — research grants pool	Associate Head (Research)	70100	Finance Office	Director of Finance
21370	Industrial Engineering — postgraduate programme	Programme Director	70200	Human Resources Office	Director of Human Resources
30440	Mechanical Engineering — machine shop	Workshop Manager	70300	Estates Office	Director of Estates
30460	Mechanical Engineering — undergraduate projects	Programme Director	70400	Communications Office	Director of Communications
30470	Mechanical Engineering — external collaborations	Associate Head (External)	80100	Research Institute for Advanced Materials	Institute Director
30480	Mechanical Engineering — equipment fund	Head of Department	80200	Research Institute for Data Science	Institute Director
30490	Mechanical Engineering — conference travel pool	Head of Department	80300	Centre for Sustainable Energy	Centre Director

Section 7. Standard Letters

The Expenses Section uses the following texts at each stage. Each letter carries the claim reference, the date and the name of the officer handling the claim.

7.1 Acknowledgement

Reference: [as shown on the acknowledgement] Date: [date of issue]

Dear Claimant,

Your travel expense claim was received by the Expenses Section on the date shown above and has been logged under the reference quoted. It will be checked within five working days and, if complete, forwarded for payment in the next payroll run.

If any item requires clarification we will write to you; otherwise no further action is needed on your part.

Yours sincerely,

Choi Su-min
Expenses Officer

7.2 Query

Reference: [as shown on the acknowledgement] Date: [date of issue]

Dear Claimant,

We have reviewed the claim referenced above and need the following before it can be approved:

1. The original receipt for the item listed on line 3 of the receipts table; the document enclosed is a booking confirmation, which does not show payment.
2. Confirmation of whether breakfast was included in the hotel rate, so that the subsistence claim can be checked.
3. The travel authorisation number, which is not quoted on the form.

Please reply within 14 days. The claim will be held in the meantime.

Yours sincerely,

Choi Su-min
Expenses Officer

7.3 Return for correction

Reference: [as shown on the acknowledgement] Date: [date of issue]

Dear Claimant,

The claim referenced above is returned for correction for the reason stated below. Please amend the form, initial the amendment, and resubmit through your departmental office.

Reason: the expense type entered for line 2 does not match the receipt. A hotel invoice is claimed as Travelling - Accommodation, not as Others.

A corrected claim re-enters the queue on the date it is received.

Yours sincerely,

Daniel Okoro
Senior Expenses Officer

7.4 Payment advice

Reference: [as shown on the acknowledgement] Date: [date of issue]

Dear Claimant,

The claim referenced above has been approved and will be paid to your salary account in the payroll run on the date shown. The amount paid is the total claimed less any advance and less any item disallowed; disallowed items and the reasons are listed on the enclosed statement.

If you disagree with a disallowance, Section 8 of the pack explains how to appeal.

Yours sincerely,

Daniel Okoro
Senior Expenses Officer

7.5 Advance approval

Reference: [as shown on the acknowledgement] Date: [date of issue]

Dear Claimant,

Your request for a travel advance against the authorisation referenced above has been approved. The amount will be paid to your salary account within three working days and must be accounted for on the expense claim submitted after the journey. Any balance not accounted for is repayable within 14 days of return.

Yours sincerely,

Choi Su-min
Expenses Officer

7.6 Notice of recovery

Reference: [as shown on the acknowledgement] Date: [date of issue]

Dear Claimant,

Following the audit of the claim referenced above, an amount has been identified as paid in error for the reason stated on the enclosed statement. Under Section 8.3 of the Travel and Expenses Policy the amount will be recovered by deduction from salary in equal instalments over the next three months, beginning with the next payroll run, unless you appeal within 30 days of the date of this letter.

Yours sincerely,

Daniel Okoro
Senior Expenses Officer

7.7 Late claim accepted

Reference: [as shown on the acknowledgement] Date: [date of issue]

Dear Claimant,

The claim referenced above was submitted more than 60 days after the return date. The head of department's written approval and your explanation of the delay have been received and accepted, and the claim has been passed for processing in the normal way. Please note that a claim submitted more than six months after the return date cannot be accepted.

Yours sincerely,

Choi Su-min
Expenses Officer

7.8 Appeal outcome

Reference: [as shown on the acknowledgement] Date: [date of issue]

Dear Claimant,

I have considered your appeal against the disallowance on the claim referenced above, together with the additional information you supplied. My decision and the reasons for it are set out below. Where the appeal is upheld in whole or in part, the amount will be paid in the next payroll run. A further appeal lies to the Vice-President (Administration) within 30 days.

Yours sincerely,

Director of Finance

Section 8. Audit, Compliance and Appeals

8.1 Checks applied to every claim

1. Identity: the name and staff number match the payroll record, and the claimant is an eligible person.
2. Authorisation: a travel authorisation exists for the journey and its dates.
3. Arithmetic: each line's reimbursable amount equals the receipt amount multiplied by the exchange rate, and the totals add up.
4. Receipts: every item other than a flat-rate allowance is supported by a receipt or a countersigned declaration.
5. Policy: class of travel, accommodation caps, subsistence rates and non-reimbursable items are applied.
6. Duplication: the claim does not repeat an item already reimbursed or invoiced directly to the University.

8.2 Sampling by Internal Audit

Internal Audit selects five percent of approved claims each quarter, weighted towards high-value claims and claims approved close to the delegated limit, and re-performs the checks above with reference to the underlying bookings. Findings are classified as clerical, policy or integrity. Clerical findings are corrected and noted; policy findings are reported to the head of department and any overpayment is recovered; integrity findings are referred to Human Resources.

8.3 Recovery

An overpayment is recovered by deduction from salary over not more than three months, after written notice to the claimant. A claimant who disputes the recovery may appeal under 8.4; recovery is suspended while the appeal is pending.

8.4 Appeals

A claimant who disagrees with a disallowance or a recovery may appeal in writing to the Director of Finance within 30 days of the payment advice or the notice of recovery, stating the item, the amount and the grounds. The Director of Finance responds within 20 working days. A further appeal lies to the Vice-President (Administration), whose decision is final.

8.5 Common findings

Finding	Frequency in last audit year	Usual cause
Booking confirmation submitted instead of receipt	High	Online booking platforms
Subsistence not reduced for meals provided	High	Conference packages
Wrong expense type	Medium	Registration fee claimed as Others
Exchange rate not to four decimals	Medium	Rate copied from a card statement
Claim submitted after 60 days	Medium	Fieldwork seasons
Personal days not separated	Low	Combined trips
Item invoiced directly also claimed	Low	Travel agent bookings

8.6 Retention of claim records

Approved claims and their receipts are scanned into the finance system and the paper originals are retained for seven years from the end of the financial year in which the claim was paid, or longer where a funder requires it. Grant-funded claims are retained for the period stated in the grant terms, which for some funders is ten years from the end of the project. Claimants do not need to keep their own copies but may find it useful to do so for tax purposes.

8.7 Tax treatment

Reimbursement of expenses necessarily incurred in the performance of duties is not income of the claimant and is not reported on the annual employer's return. Flat-rate allowances paid at or below the published rates are treated in the same way. Any amount paid above the published rate, or for an item that is not a business expense, is reported as income; the Expenses Section identifies such items on the payment advice.

8.8 Declaration of interests

A claimant who has a financial interest in a supplier used on a journey — for example a hotel or agency owned by a family member — must declare it on the claim form. The declaration does not by itself make the expense non-reimbursable, but the approver must confirm that the choice of supplier was reasonable.

8.9 Internal audit report extract — travel and expenses, previous audit year

Internal Audit reviewed a sample of 412 approved claims with a total value of HK\$ 6.8 million, selected from 8,240 claims paid in the year. The review re-performed the Expenses Section's checks and traced each sampled claim to the travel authorisation and to the bookings held by the appointed agent. The overall conclusion was that the control framework is adequate and operating effectively, with the exceptions noted below.

Area	Sample exceptions	Value (HK\$)	Classification	Action
Receipts	31 items supported by a booking confirmation only	48,200	Clerical	Reminder in departmental bulletin; portal upload guidance revised
Subsistence	24 claims not reduced for meals provided	9,600	Policy	Recovered; FAQ expanded
Timing	17 claims over 60 days without approval	—	Clerical	Approval obtained retrospectively
Expense type	12 items misclassified	—	Clerical	Glossary added to the pack
Class of travel	2 premium economy sectors without Dean's approval	6,400	Policy	Recovered; agent's booking control tightened
Duplication	1 hotel invoiced to the University and also claimed	3,150	Policy	Recovered
Integrity	None	—	—	—

Internal Audit recommended, and the Finance Office accepted, that the claim form be revised to carry a checklist on the reverse, that the monthly exchange rate table be included in the pack issued with each claim, and that the Expenses Section report quarterly to the Finance Committee on the number of claims returned for correction and the reasons. The first two recommendations are implemented in this version of the pack.

Section 9. Glossary

9.1 Expense types printed on the claim form

Expense type	Use for
Travelling - Airfare (Basic Economy Class)	Air tickets in economy class for a research visit, fieldwork or meeting, including taxes and booking fees
Travelling - Airfare (Other than Basic Economy Class)	Air tickets in any other class, with the authorising approval attached
Travelling - Accommodation	Hotel and other lodging on a research visit, fieldwork or meeting; room charge and taxes only
Travelling - Other Travelling Expenses	Local transport, transfers, transport passes, taxis, hire cars, fuel
Travelling - Subsistence Allowance	The flat daily rate for meals and incidentals on a research visit (subsistence table only)
Conference - Airfare (Basic Economy Class)	Air tickets in economy class where the purpose of the journey is a conference
Conference - Airfare (Other than Basic Economy Class)	Conference air tickets in any other class, with the authorising approval attached
Conference - Accommodation	Lodging during a conference; room charge and taxes only
Conference - Other Conference Expenses	Registration fees, poster printing, proceedings, conference dinner tickets where reimbursable
Conference - Subsistence Allowance	The flat daily rate for meals and incidentals during a conference
Others	Any item that fits no other type — shipping, visa fees, vaccinations, business telephone — with a full description

9.2 Terms used in correspondence

Term	Meaning
Advance	Cash issued before travel and deducted from the claim.
Approver	The budget holder who authorises the claim within the delegated limit.
Authorisation	Written approval of the journey obtained before booking.
Cap	The maximum nightly accommodation charge reimbursed for a destination.
Cost centre	The five-digit code of the unit or grant charged with the expense.
Disallowance	An item, or part of an item, not reimbursed, with the reason stated.
Flat rate	An allowance paid without receipts at a published rate.
Monthly rate	The exchange rate published by the Finance Office for a calendar month.
Night	A night spent away from Hong Kong on business, counted from departure to return.
Payroll run	The monthly payment cycle through which expenses are paid.
Receipt	A document from the supplier showing what was bought, when, and the amount paid.
Reimbursable amount	The receipt amount converted to Hong Kong dollars at the rate used.
Subsistence	Meals and incidental expenses while away overnight, paid at the flat rate.

Section 10. Contacts and Document Control

10.1 Contacts

Function	Contact	Hours
Expenses Section enquiries	expenses@univ.edu.hk; 3411 5200	Monday to Friday 9:00–17:30
Travel authorisation and advances	travel@univ.edu.hk; 3411 5210	Monday to Friday 9:00–17:30
Appointed travel agent (bookings)	3411 5299 (dedicated line)	Monday to Saturday 9:00–18:00
Payroll (payment queries)	payroll@univ.edu.hk; 3411 5100	Monday to Friday 9:00–17:30
Internal Audit	audit@univ.edu.hk	By appointment
Director of Finance (appeals)	In writing, Room 3.01, Administration Building	—

10.2 Document control

Version	Date	Change	Approved by
4.0	01/08/2022	Policy consolidated with rate tables into one pack	Finance Committee
4.1	01/01/2024	Subsistence rates revised; class of travel table added	Director of Finance
4.2	01/08/2024	Electronic submission pilot; FAQ added	Director of Finance
5.0	01/01/2026	Form EXPGEN2 revision; 2026 rates; monthly exchange rate table	Finance Committee

This pack is issued with a claim so that the form, the rules under which it is assessed and the supporting material are kept together. The claim form in Section 4 is the only part completed by the claimant; all other sections are for reference.

End of pack.

Section 11. Statement of Financial Responsibility

Every member of staff who incurs or approves expenditure on behalf of the University accepts the responsibilities set out in the Financial Regulations, of which this statement is an extract. The Regulations are available on the Finance Office intranet and prevail over this extract.

1. Expenditure may be incurred only for the purposes of the University, within an approved budget, and in accordance with the policies in force.
2. A person who incurs expenditure must obtain the authorisation required before committing the University, must obtain value for money, and must retain the evidence needed to support the expenditure.
3. A person who approves expenditure must be satisfied that it is proper, that it is within budget, and that the evidence is adequate, and must not approve expenditure in which he or she has a personal interest.
4. Any gift, hospitality or other benefit offered by a supplier in connection with University business must be declared in the register maintained by the department, and may be accepted only where it is modest and could not reasonably be seen to influence a decision.
5. Suspected fraud, theft or irregularity must be reported to the Director of Finance or through the University's confidential reporting line, and must not be investigated by the person who discovers it.
6. Breach of the Financial Regulations may be treated as misconduct under the disciplinary procedure and may result in the withdrawal of authority to incur or approve expenditure.

The claimant's signature on the expense claim form is a declaration that the claim complies with this statement and with the Travel and Expenses Policy.

